

Claims & Argument Structure

Workbook 2 - Apply - Focused practice

Directions

Treat each item as close-choice practice. Preserve scope, certainty, and the exact job of each piece of evidence.

Exercise 1

A town planner argues for adding shade near the two busiest transit stops. She cites rider counts, afternoon temperature readings, and a survey in which riders named heat as a reason they avoid waiting for the bus. She does not propose covering every stop.

Task: Which statement best captures the argument chain?

- A. Heat exists, so every stop should receive a shelter immediately.
- B. The busiest stops have measurable heat exposure and rider concern, so targeted shade should be tested there first.
- C. Riders dislike buses, so the town should reduce service.
- D. Temperature readings alone prove shade will increase ridership.

Exercise 2

A principal supports a phone-free lunch pilot. She says students report wanting more face-to-face conversation, teachers observed fewer lunchroom disputes during two trial days, and the school should test the policy for one month before deciding whether to keep it.

Task: Which statement is a supporting claim rather than the main claim?

- A. The school should test a phone-free lunch policy for one month.
- B. Reducing phone use at lunch may encourage more direct student interaction.
- C. Teachers work at the school.
- D. The school should permanently ban phones everywhere.

Exercise 3

An article argues that a river trail should be repaired in stages. Paragraph 2 describes erosion near the northern section. Paragraph 3 estimates repair costs. Paragraph 4 recommends fixing the highest-risk segment first and monitoring the rest.

Task: What role does Paragraph 3 play?

- A. It provides cost information that helps justify a staged repair.
- B. It changes the topic from trail repair to tourism.
- C. It proves the northern section is the only damaged area.
- D. It states the main claim without support.

Exercise 4

A company memo argues for rotating one remote-work day among departments. It cites desk-capacity limits, reports that customer response times were unchanged during a trial, and notes that teams can choose different days.

Task: Which option is the best concise thesis?

- A. Remote work is popular.
- B. The company has desks.
- C. A rotating remote-work day can reduce space pressure without reducing customer coverage, so the company should continue a controlled version of the policy.
- D. Every employee should work remotely whenever desired.

Answer reasoning

Check your reasoning, not only your answer.

For every question, compare your reasoning with the explanation. If you missed the item, identify the exact step where your reasoning changed the source or used evidence for the wrong job.

Exercise 1

Best answer: B. The busiest stops have measurable heat exposure and rider concern, so targeted shade should be tested there first.

Why: It preserves the targeted scope and connects the evidence to the recommendation without overstating what the data prove.

Exercise 2

Best answer: B. Reducing phone use at lunch may encourage more direct student interaction.

Why: It is a reason supporting the one-month pilot. The pilot itself is the main recommendation.

Exercise 3

Best answer: A. It provides cost information that helps justify a staged repair.

Why: The cost estimate helps explain why the author recommends prioritizing rather than repairing everything at once.

Exercise 4

Best answer: C. A rotating remote-work day can reduce space pressure without reducing customer coverage, so the company should continue a controlled version of the policy.

Why: It captures the position, the central reasons, and the limited scope.

Mistake check

For every miss, label the reason: wrong claim, evidence mismatch, too broad or too certain, reasoning gap, source or format confusion, or rushed reading. Then write one sentence explaining what you will check next time.